

Full-Stack Capstone

Eight build cycles, one architecture, one shipped container. React + Vite + TypeScript · Go + HTTP · persistent store · AI integration · auth · Docker.

DURATION 8 hr (2 breaks + lunch)

AUDIENCE Capstone candidates

PREREQ Courses 1–4 + deployed tool + proposal

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COURSE 6 · FACILITATOR PACK

0:00–0:30 M1 Full-Stack Frontier FRAMING	0:30–1:15 M2 Environment Setup SETUP	1:15–2:00 M3 Backend from Scratch BUILD · ARCH 1/4	2:00–2:45 M4 Data Layer BUILD · ARCH 2/4	2:45–3:00 Break 15 MIN	3:00–3:45 M5 Frontend from Scratch BUILD · ARCH 3/4	3:45–4:30 M6 Pages & Navigation BUILD	4:30–5:15 M7 AI Chat Integration BUILD	5:15–5:30 Break (often lunch) 15 MIN	5:30–6:15 M8 Auth & Middleware BUILD	6:15–7:00 M9 External Integrations BUILD · COMPRESS HERE	7:00–7:45 M10 Docker & Deploy BUILD · ARCH 4/4	7:45–8:00 Assessment & Wrap CLOSE
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PRE-SESSION PREP

Done 1 week before; verified at T-60 min

- **Capstone gate.** Every attendee submitted a proposal >= 7 days out. Reject anyone without an approved proposal — 8 hours is no place to discover scope drift.
- **Machines.** Each laptop runs Node 20+, Go 1.22+, Docker Desktop (admin), VS Code or equivalent, GenAI.mil access, GitHub or local repo. Smoke-test 24 h before.
- **Architecture diagram** printed and posted in the room (and on a side monitor). It is the one slide you return to nine times today.
- **Catering / break logistics.** Coffee at 0815, snacks at 1045 and 1530, lunch decision at 1230 (M7 break often becomes lunch). Hangry rooms break things.
- **Stretch goals doc.** Per-student: a 3-bullet stretch list to deploy on top of the base stack if they finish early.

LIVE HAND-OFF CUES

Constant deck → IDE switching — the architecture is the anchor

- **End of M2.** Return to the architecture slide. *Stop.* Point at it. “You will see this exact picture eight more times today.”
- **Module-complete cadence.** Each build module ends with a 60-second “arch lights up” slide. Deck → diagram → back to IDE for the next build.
- **End of M3 (1st curl response).** Twenty seconds of silence. This is the emotional checkpoint of the day — let it land.
- **M9 compression rule.** If you’re behind by 15 min entering M9, cut external integrations to a stub. Everyone ships a container by 1700 — no exceptions.
- **1700 wrap.** Each student demos their running container in 60 sec. You moderate; you do not debug.

EXERCISE & ACTIVITY PROMPTS

Read these to the room verbatim

- M1 (30 min).** “You stop being a Power Apps builder today. Today you direct AI to build whatever the problem needs — backend, frontend, data, auth. Look at the architecture. Four layers. Eight builds. One container at 1700.”
- M2 (45 min).** “Most boring module of the day; most expensive if we skip it. Verify Node, Go, Docker. AI walks each of you through your own machine — do not let me do it for you.”
- M3 (45 min).** “Direct AI to write a Go HTTP server that returns a hard-coded JSON array on `GET /items`. You curl it. When you see `200 OK`, raise a hand. Twenty-second pause for everyone to feel that.”
- M4 (45 min).** “Interface-first. Define what the data layer *does* before you decide how it stores. AI implements the interface against an in-memory store first; persistence in a stretch.”
- M5–M6 (90 min).** “React + Vite + TypeScript. Proxy to the Go backend. Render the items table. Then add routes for two pages and a nav. Resist beauty — we add features in M6, polish never.”
- M7 (45 min).** “Wire the OpenAI-compatible chat endpoint to your backend. Stream tokens to the React UI. The first time it streams, applaud once.”
- M8 (45 min).** “Auth middleware on the backend; login route on the frontend. Single test user. Real password hashing. No production claims yet.”
- M9 (45 min, compressible).** “One external integration of your choice from the proposal. If the API gives you trouble — stub it. M10 is non-negotiable.”
- M10 (45 min).** “Dockerfile, build, run. Ship the container. URL or screenshot in chat by 1745.”
- ANCHOR PHRASE** “Architecture first. Light up one box at a time. Everyone ships a container by 1700.”

WHEN THIS GOES SIDEWAYS

Top failure modes & recovery

- **Docker won't install (admin denied) on a student machine.**
→ Defer Docker to M10; pair the student with a Docker-enabled buddy for the deploy. They still ship.
- **External API in M9 returns 401s the entire module.**
→ Stub it. Hard-code a sample response. M9 is the compressible one for a reason.
- **A student wants to make the M5 table beautiful.**
→ Stop them. “Polish is for after 1700. Get data on the page.” Bookmark their idea for the stretch list.
- **CORS / proxy errors stall multiple students at M5.**
→ Project the Vite proxy config slide. Walk through it once for the room. Do not re-explain individually — pair them up.
- **Behind 30+ minutes entering M8.**
→ Cut M9 entirely (announce it explicitly). Re-allocate to M10 so the container ships. Capture the missed module as Day-2 homework.

POST-SESSION PREP

Issued in the 1745 wrap; capstone hand-off

- **Push the container** to your unit’s registry within 72 h. URL goes in the program shared library.
- **Write the Unit Playbook** for hand-off to the next rotation: architecture diagram, run instructions, two known issues, one stretch goal. Use the Week 4 playbook template.
- **Run a 30-min teach-back** with two non-attendees in the next 30 days. Show the container. Show the architecture diagram. Take their first three questions to the program lead.
- **Capstone certificate** issued after playbook submission & teach-back evidence are received.